

Technology & Social Interaction - Strong Task 2

Sample Submission for IELTS Writing Evaluation

In recent decades, rapid advancements in digital technology have fundamentally transformed the way individuals communicate and interact. While some argue that this shift has rendered society increasingly isolated, others contend that technology has merely redefined the nature of social connection. In my view, although technology presents certain social challenges, its overall impact on human interaction is largely positive when used responsibly. Proponents of the view that technology undermines social bonds often point to the prevalence of screen time at the expense of face-to-face interaction. Research conducted by the American Psychological Association suggests that excessive social media use is correlated with heightened feelings of loneliness and anxiety, particularly among adolescents. Furthermore, the phenomenon of phubbing, whereby individuals prioritise their devices over present company, has become increasingly normalised, potentially eroding the quality of personal relationships. Nevertheless, it would be an oversimplification to conclude that technology is inherently antisocial. Platforms such as video calling applications have enabled individuals to maintain meaningful relationships across vast geographical distances, a feat that would have been impossible a generation ago. Moreover, online communities provide valuable spaces for individuals with niche interests or marginalised identities to find connection and support. In conclusion, while the misuse of technology can undoubtedly contribute to social fragmentation, its responsible application holds considerable potential to enrich and broaden human connection. It is therefore the manner in which technology is used, rather than technology itself, that determines its social impact.